

Fictora Content Producer Setup

Fictora episode production — setup handout for content producers

Repository: <https://github.com/DreamFlux-Workspace/fictora-content-creation>
Audience: Content producers using Cursor with the episode-production skill
Updated: September 2026

1. What this is

You produce short **9:16 vertical episodes** (~15 seconds) using:

- This **GitHub repo** (tools + agent instructions only)
- **Cursor** (AI agent runs production steps)
- The hosted **Drama Generation API** (drawing, boards, filming, post on Fictora servers)

You do **not** need the private fictora-drama repository. Your review surface is a **desk folder** on your Mac (~/Downloads/documents/...) with plates/, boards/, and takes/.

You **approve** faces, script lines, and storyboards **before** the ~\$1.20 take is filmed.

2. What you need from DreamFlux / engineering

Item	Notes
GitHub access	Clone DreamFlux-Workspace/fictora-content-creation
API service token	See Section 3 — required in .env
Cursor (recommended)	Open the cloned repo as the workspace
macOS	Tested workflow; Linux likely works with uv

Security: Never paste the API token into Cursor chat, Slack, or email. Never commit the .env file.

3. Environment variables (required setup)

Create a file named .env in the repo root (copy from .env.example).

Required

Variable	Description
FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_SERVICE_TOKEN	Bearer token for all /v1/ API calls. Required. Ask engineering if you do not have it.

Optional

Variable	If unset
FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_API_BASE_URL	Defaults to production: <code>https://fictora-drama-generation-prod-drama.up.railway.app</code>
FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_SESSION_ID	Each desk stores its own session in <code>production.json</code> after you run <code>start</code> — you usually leave this commented out

Minimal .env example

```
FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_API_BASE_URL=https://fictora-drama-generation-prod-drama.up.railway.app
FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_SERVICE_TOKEN=paste-your-token-here
```

Desk files (not environment variables)

After you start a series, the agent uses files on your desk:

File	Purpose
<desk>/production.json	Current phase, spine id, session id
<desk>/production.config.json	Clip length (15s), captions (house), draft episode count (4)

4. One-time machine setup (~10 minutes)

1. **Install uv** (Python tool runner): <https://docs.astral.sh/uv/>

2. **Clone the repo:**

```
git clone https://github.com/DreamFlux-Workspace/fictora-content-creation.git
cd fictora-content-creation
```

3. **Configure credentials:**

```
cp .env.example .env
```

Open `.env` in a text editor and set `FICTORA_DRAMA_GENERATION_SERVICE_TOKEN`.

4. **Install project dependencies:**

```
uv sync
```

5. **Open the repo folder in Cursor.** The included **episode-production** skill tells the agent how to run production safely (human gates, one paid step per turn).

6. **Verify read-only API access (optional):**

```
uv run python scripts/smoke_live.py --phase read
```

This checks presets and desk tooling without spending on LLM/video.

5. Production flow (your role vs the agent)

```
Brief + draft → Cast plates → [YOU: plates ok] → Script → [YOU: script ok]
→ Storyboard → [YOU: board ok] → Price estimate → [YOU: yes to spend]
```

→ Film take (long wait) → Review video in takes/

Step	You open	You say
Plates	ep01/plates/	“plates ok” or what is wrong
Script	lines in chat / scripts/	“script ok” or revised lines
Board	ep01/boards/	“board ok” (or accept dim board if agent warns)
Cost	number in chat	“yes” to spend, or stop
Take	ep01/takes/	use it, or ask for a fix with a clear cause

Silence is not approval. Each episode needs fresh yeses at each gate.

Starting a new series (paste to Cursor)

Start episode production for “[Series Name]”. Band 15s, MiniMax H3, visual-first ep1. Premise: [your prompt]. Put the desk under ~/Downloads/documents/.

6. Desk folder layout

```
my-series-2026-09-22/
  production.json
  production.config.json
  ep01/
    brief.md
    plates/          ← approve faces
    scripts/
    boards/          ← approve storyboard
    takes/           ← finished video
    api/             ← JSON logs (debugging)
    run-notes.md
```

7. Useful commands (agent usually runs these)

Action	Command
Start desk	<code>uv run fictora-produce start --series "..." --prompt "..." --band 15s</code>
Next API step	<code>uv run fictora-produce step --desk <desk-path></code>
Approve gate	<code>uv run fictora-produce approve --desk <path> --gate plates (or script, board)</code>
Approve dim board	<code>add --accept-dim to board approve</code>
Confirm spend + film	<code>uv run fictora-produce step --desk <path> --confirm-spend</code>
Status	<code>uv run fictora-produce status --desk <path></code>

8. Captions and audio

- Subtitles are **not** generated by the video model. They are **burned in during post-production** (default style: house — yellow text, black edge).
- Mid-job previews often have **no captions** yet. Use the file in takes/ after the job reaches **completed**.

- Captions may only appear for **a few seconds** around the spoken line—scrub to that beat when reviewing.
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9. When something goes wrong

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
“Error reading body from connection”	Network blip while polling	Run step again on the same desk ; job often still running server-side
Stuck at 50% 20–30+ min	Post-production (mix, captions)	Wait; ask agent to check API job status
503 restate_unavailable	Server orchestration down	Retry later; contact engineering
No file in takes/	Poll stopped early or delivery not fetched	Re-run step on same desk (resume without double-charging if enrol already saved)

10. Rules of the road

- Do **not** clone fictora-drama.
 - Do **not** approve plates, script, and board without opening the files.
 - Do **not** share your token or commit `.env`.
 - Do **not** film twice in parallel on the same desk without engineering guidance.
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11. More documentation (in the repo)

- README.md — technical overview
 - docs/Episode-Production-Partner-Guide.md — expanded partner guide
 - docs/content-ops/runbook.md — full production craft runbook
 - .cursor/skills/episode-production/SKILL.md — agent instructions
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12. Support

- **Token, outages, billing:** DreamFlux / Fictora engineering contact
- **Day-to-day production:** Cursor + this repo + human gates in Section 5